

Word family: **particular / particularly / particularity / particulars**

Base word: particular

Part of speech: mainly **adjective**, also **noun**

Related forms:

* **particular** (adj.) — 特定的；某一個的；特別講究的；詳細的

* **particularly** (adv.) — 特別；尤其

* **particularity** (n.) — 特殊性；講究；細節性

* **particulars** (plural noun) — 詳情；資料；細節

Useful expressions / extensions:

* **a particular person / thing**

* **this particular**

* **one particular**

* **in particular**

* **nothing in particular**

* **particular about**

* **particular attention**

* **particular care**

* **for no particular reason**

* **particulars of**

* **particularly**

* **be particular about**

Meaning in this passage

> I decided to give her that album because I wanted to give her something with emotional weight rather than something merely practical.

And the section heading says:

> Why I chose this **particular** gift

Here, **particular** means:

this specific one, rather than other possible ones — 這一份特定的；這個特別指定的

中文翻譯：

我為甚麼選擇**這一份特定的禮物**。

So here:

this particular gift = 這一份特定的禮物，而不是其他可能的禮物

1. **particular (特定的；某一個的) — 特定的；某個的**

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Practice 1 — passage-related

> Why did you choose this **particular gift**?

你為甚麼選擇**這一份特定的禮物**？

Practice 2

> I'm looking for a **particular book**.

我正在找**某一本特定的書**。

Practice 3

> There was one **particular moment** I remembered clearly.

有**某一個特定時刻**我記得很清楚。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****particular = 指眾多可能的人、物或情況中的某一個特定對象****

2. **this / that particular — 這個 / 那個特定的**

Practice 1

> I don't remember **that particular day**.

我不記得**那一天的具體情況**。

Practice 2

> Why are you interested in **this particular topic**?

你為甚麼對**這個特定主題**有興趣？

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****this/that particular X = 特別指出某一個具體的 X****

3. ****one particular — 某一個特別指定的****

Practice 1

> ****One particular photo**** made her laugh.

****其中某一張特定照片****令她笑了。

Practice 2

> I remember ****one particular teacher**** from school.

我記得學生時代****某一位特別的老師****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****one particular X = 在多個同類事物中，特別指其中某一個****

4. ****in particular — 尤其；特別是****

A major fixed expression.

Practice 1

> I liked the whole album, but one page ****in particular**** stood out.

我喜歡整本相簿，但****尤其有一頁****特別突出。

Practice 2

> She enjoys fruit, oranges ****in particular****.

她喜歡水果，****尤其是橙****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****in particular = 在一個較大範圍中，特別指出某一個人、物或部分****

5. **nothing in particular — 沒有特別的；沒甚麼特定的**

Practice 1

> What are you doing? — **Nothing in particular**.

你在做甚麼？——**沒甚麼特別的**。

Practice 2

> I went out for **no particular reason**.

我出門**沒有甚麼特別原因**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****nothing/no particular X = 沒有某個特別指定或明確的 X****

6. **for no particular reason — 沒有特別原因**

Practice 1

> He smiled **for no particular reason**.

他**沒有特別原因**就笑了。

Practice 2

> I chose that seat **for no particular reason**.

我選那個座位**沒有甚麼特別原因**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****for no particular reason = 沒有一個明確或特殊的原因****

7. **particular (講究的；挑剔的) — 講究的；挑剔的**

A major distinct adjective sense.

Practice 1

> She's very **particular about food**.

她對食物非常**講究 / 挑剔**。

Practice 2

> He is **particular about how his desk is arranged**.

他很**講究**書桌的擺放方式。

MCQ-ready definition:

particular = 對細節、標準或選擇有明確而嚴格的要求

8. **be particular about something — 對.....很講究**

Practice 1

> My father is very **particular about coffee**.

我爸爸對咖啡很**講究**。

Practice 2

> She's **particular about grammar**.

她對文法很**講究**。

MCQ-ready definition:

be particular about X = 對 X 的質素、方式或細節有高要求

9. **particular attention — 特別注意**

Practice 1

> Pay **particular attention** to the final paragraph.

請**特別留意**最後一段。

Practice 2

> The teacher gave **particular attention** to weaker students.

老師對較弱的學生給予**特別關注**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****particular attention = 比一般情況更多、更集中地注意某事****

10. ****particular care — 特別小心；格外留意****

Practice 1

> Take ****particular care**** when crossing the road.

過馬路時要****格外小心****。

Practice 2

> The old photos were handled with ****particular care****.

那些舊照片被****格外小心地****處理。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****particular care = 比平常更仔細、更謹慎的處理方式****

11. ****particular (詳細的；精確指定的) — 具體的；詳細的****

Less common as a direct adjective today, but still appears in formal usage.

Practice 1

> Please give ****particular details**** of what happened.

請提供事件的****具體細節****。

Practice 2

> The report was very ****particular**** in its description.

這份報告在描述上非常****詳細具體****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****particular = 涉及具體細節，而不是籠統概括****

12. ****particulars (詳情；資料) — 詳情；細節；資料****

This plural noun is important.

Practice 1

> Please provide your **personal particulars**.

請提供你的**個人資料**。

Practice 2

> The police recorded the **particulars of the incident**.

警方記錄了事件的**詳細資料**。

MCQ-ready definition:

particulars = 某人、事件或安排的詳細資料或具體內容

13. **personal particulars** — 個人資料

Practice 1

> Fill in your **personal particulars** on the form.

請在表格上填寫你的**個人資料**。

Practice 2

> The document contains his **personal particulars**.

文件載有他的**個人資料**。

MCQ-ready definition:

personal particulars = 姓名、地址、出生日期等具體個人資料

14. **particulars of something** —的詳情

Practice 1

> We need the **particulars of the agreement**.

我們需要這份協議的**詳細資料**。

Practice 2

> She gave me the **particulars of the meeting**.

她告訴我會議的**具體詳情**。

MCQ-ready definition:

particulars of X = 關於 X 的具體細節和資料

15. **particularly** — 特別；尤其

Practice 1

> I **particularly** liked the handwritten notes.

我**尤其**喜歡那些手寫紙條。

Practice 2

> The room was **particularly** quiet that evening.

那天晚上房間**特別**安靜。

MCQ-ready definition:

particularly = 比其他情況更明顯；尤其

16. **not particularly** — 不特別；不太

A very common conversational use.

Practice 1

> I'm **not particularly hungry**.

我**不太餓**。

Practice 2

> The film wasn't **particularly interesting**.

那部電影**不算特別有趣**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****not particularly = 程度不高；不算特別****

17. ****particularly important / useful / difficult — 特別重要 / 有用 / 困難****

Practice 1

> This point is ****particularly important****.

這一點****尤其重要****。

Practice 2

> The final question was ****particularly difficult****.

最後一題****特別困難****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****particularly + adjective = 強調某種特質的程度比一般更高****

18. ****particularity (特殊性；特徵) — 特殊性；獨特之處****

Practice 1

> We should preserve the ****particularity**** of the local culture.

我們應保留本地文化的****獨特性****。

Practice 2

> The design has a certain ****particularity****.

這個設計有某種****獨特之處****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****particularity = 使某人或某物有別於其他事物的特殊性或細節****

This form is much less common in everyday English than ****particular**** or ****particularly****.

Important distinction 1: **particular vs specific**

These often overlap strongly.

specific

emphasizes exactness and clear identification.

particular

often emphasizes one selected member of a larger group.

> a specific date

一個明確日期

> this particular gift

這一份特定禮物

In many contexts, either works.

Important distinction 2: **particular vs special**

Very important.

particular

= specific; one certain one.

special

= unusual, important, meaningful, better than ordinary.

> this particular gift

這一份特定的禮物

> a special gift

一份特別 / 有特殊意義的禮物

Your heading uses **particular**, not **special**.

Important distinction 3: **particular vs certain**

a particular person

a specific person.

a certain person

some specific person whose identity may be unstated.

> A certain man called yesterday.

昨天有某個男人打來。

Certain often deliberately avoids naming who.

Important distinction 4: **particular vs individual**

particular

points to one specific case.

individual

emphasizes one separate member/unit.

> this particular student

這位特定學生

> individual students

個別學生

Important distinction 5: **particular vs picky**

particular

can politely mean having high standards.

picky

more informal and often more negative.

> She's particular about food.

她對食物很講究。

> She's a picky eater.

她很挑食。

So **particular** is often softer.

Important distinction 6: **particular vs fussy**

particular

careful about standards/preferences.

fussy

often implies excessive concern over small details.

> particular about cleanliness

對清潔很講究

> fussy about every tiny detail

對每個小細節都太挑剔

Important distinction 7: **in particular vs particularly**

They are related but grammatically different.

in particular

usually singles out a noun/item.

> I liked the photos, one **in particular**.

我喜歡那些照片，尤其其中一張。

particularly

usually modifies an adjective, verb, or clause.

> I **particularly** liked one photo.

我尤其喜歡其中一張照片。

Important distinction 8: **particular about vs particular to**

These are very different.

particular about X

fussy/careful about X.

> particular about clothes

對衣服很講究

particular to X

specific or unique to X.

> a feature particular to this region

這個地區特有的特徵

19. **particular to something — 某事物特有的**

Practice 1

> This problem is **particular to older buildings**.

這個問題是**舊建築特有的**。

Practice 2

> The custom is **particular to this region**.

這個習俗是**這個地區特有的**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****particular to X = 只在 X 中出現或與 X 特別相關****

Important distinction 9: ****in particular vs especially****

Very close.

**in particular**

often singles out one member.

**especially**

can more broadly emphasize degree or importance.

> I like fruit, oranges in particular.

我喜歡水果，尤其是橙。

> This is especially useful for beginners.

這對初學者特別有用。

Important distinction 10: ****no particular reason vs no reason****

**no reason**

suggests there is no reason.

**no particular reason**

means no specific or noteworthy reason.

> I went for no particular reason.

= 我只是隨意去，沒有甚麼特別原因。

This is softer and more natural in many contexts.

Important distinction 11: ****particular attention vs attention to detail****

****particular attention****

extra focus on one thing.

****attention to detail****

habit/ability of noticing small details.

> Pay particular attention to Question 5.

特別留意第五題。

> She has excellent attention to detail.

她很注重細節。

Important distinction 12: ****particulars vs details****

Very close.

****details****

general everyday word.

****particulars****

more formal and often administrative/legal.

> personal details

日常常見

> personal particulars

較正式 / 表格用語

Family-extension note

****Particular**** has four main modern branches:

1. **specific / one certain**

- * this particular gift
- * one particular day

2. **especially / singled out**

- * in particular
- * particularly

3. **fussy / demanding about details**

- * particular about food
- * particular about grammar

4. **details / specific information**

- * particulars
- * personal particulars

There is also a useful construction:

5. **particular to X**

- * X 特有的

The key learner trap is that **particular** does **not** always mean 「特別的」 in the sense of “special.” Very often it simply means **「特定的 / 某一個的」**.

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea
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particular	特定的；某一個的	one specific
this particular X	這個特定的 X	singled-out item
one particular X	某一個特定的 X	one among many
in particular	尤其；特別是	single out
nothing in particular	沒甚麼特別的	nothing specific
no particular reason	沒有特別原因	no specific reason
particular about X	對 X 很講究	high standards
particular attention	特別注意	extra focus
particular care	格外小心	extra care
particular to X	X 特有的	specific to

particulars	詳情；資料	specific details	
personal particulars	個人資料	administrative details	
particularly	特別；尤其	emphasis	
not particularly	不太；不算特別	limited degree	
particularity	特殊性；獨特之處	distinctive quality	

For your original passage heading

> Why I chose this ****particular gift****

Here:

****particular = 特定的；在其他可能的禮物之中，特別指這一份****

The most natural Traditional Chinese is:

> 我為甚麼選擇****這一份禮物****

or, if you want to make the English nuance explicit:

> 我為甚麼選擇****這一份特定的禮物****

It does ****not**** primarily mean:

> ****special = 很特別、很有意義****

Even though the gift **was** special and meaningful in the story, ****particular**** itself here is doing the job of ****identifying one specific gift among the alternatives****.